MIL-C-51251A(EA)
11 May 1988
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-51251(MU)
6 April 1966

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CLOTH, COATED; CBR PROTECTIVE

This specification is approved for use within U.S. Army Chemical Research, Development and Engineering Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of butyl coated nylon cloth.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-P-1136 - Packaging of Coated (Plastics; Rubber) and Laminated Fabrics.

MILITARY

MIL-C-7020 - Cloth, Parachute, Nylon.
MIL-D-12468 - Decontaminating Agent, STB.

: Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed: to: Commander, U.S. Army Chemical Research, Development and Engineering Center, ATTN: SMCCR-SPT-S, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21010-5423 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8305

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-109 - Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions.
MIL-STD-282 - Filter Units, Protective Clothing, Gas Mask Components and Related Products: Performance Test Methods.
MIL-STD-1487 - Glossary of Cloth Coating Imperfections.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issue of the nongovernment documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

ASTM STANDARDS

D 751 - Coated Fabrics (DOD adopted).

(Application for copies should be addressed to ASTM, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards), the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Base fabric. The base fabric shall be nylon cloth conforming to type I of MIL-C-7020 except the color shall be natural and the air permeability requirement and silicone oil treatment shall not apply.

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3.1.2 Coating compound. The coating compound shall be a butyl rubber composition. No natural rubber, reclaimed rubber, or synthetic rubber other than butyl shall be used.

3.1.3 Coating. The coating compound shall be applied to both sides of the base fabric after which it shall be fully vulcanized. The distribution of coating shall be 50 to 75 percent on one side with the balance on the other side. Both sides shall be dusted with a non-abrasive powder to prevent blocking and to produce a uniform dull finish.

3.1.4 Age. The coated cloth shall be not more than 30 months old from the date of manufacture of the nylon base fabric to the date of submission of end item test results to the Government.

3.2 Physical and chemical requirements. The coated cloth shall conform to table I when tested as specified in table V.

3.3 Length. Each roll shall contain from 180 to 220 linear yards and shall consist of no more than four pieces with no single piece being less than 6 yards long. The ends of the pieces shall be overlapped and not joined by a seam.

3.4 Width. The width shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2).

3.5 Odor. The coated cloth shall be free from any odor, except the characteristic odor of the coating compound.

3.6 Color. The color of the coated cloth shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2 and 6.7).

3.7 Marking. The words "HEAVY SIDE" shall be stenciled in legible 1/2-inch black letters on the heavier coated side (or on either side if the coating is equally distributed on both sides) of each roll. The marking shall be located within 2 inches from one edge and spaced no more than 1 yard apart.

3.8 First article. Prior to the start of regular production, a first article sample of coated cloth shall be produced in accordance with this specification for examination and test (see 4.3). Changes in formulation or processing techniques shall require a new first article sample.

3.9 Workmanship. The coated cloth shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

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TABLE I. Physical and chemical requirements

Characteristic	Minimum	Maximum
Weight, ounces per square yard	6.5	7.5
Puncture strength, pounds	10	---
Initial breaking strength, pounds		
Warp	50	---
Fill	45	---
Breaking strength, after weatherometer and after decontamination, pounds		
Warp	40	---
Fill	35	---
Hydrostatic resistance, pounds per square inch	60	---
Bow and bias, inches	---	2.5
Coating adhesion, pounds per 2-inch width	4	---
Abrasion resistance	pass*	---
Stiffness, warp, centimeters		
At 70 ± 2°F	---	8.0
At -20 ± 2°F	---	9.0
Agent resistance, initial, after weatherometer and after decontamination, minutes		
Mustard (HD)	30	---
GB	30	---
Blocking	---	No. 2
Color fastness after weatherometer and after decontamination	**	---

*After having been abraded, no base fabric shall be exposed in the center one inch of the abraded portion.
**The color of the coated cloth shall not be substantially changed.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified

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in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use any commercial laboratory certified by the Government as qualified to perform the specified toxicological agent tests and his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the remaining inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to insure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.1.2 Objective evidence. The contractor shall provide objective evidence acceptable to the contracting officer that the requirements of 3.1 and section 5 for which specific inspection has not been provided in this specification have been satisfied. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to inspect such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

(a) First aricle inspection (see 4.3).
(b) Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection.

4.3.1 Sample. Prior to the start of regular production, a 7 yard, full width sample of the coated cloth shall be produced using the same methods, materials, equipment and processes as will be used in regular production. Four yards of the sample shall be used for testing all physical and chemical requirements, except for toxicological agent resistance. The remaining 3 yards of the sample shall be used for testing toxicological agent resistance initially, after weatherometer, and after decontamination.

4.3.2 Inspection procedure.

4.3.2.1 For examination and test. As determined by the Government, the first article sample of the coated cloth shall be examined and tested for any or all of the requirements of this specification.

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4.3.2.2 Rejection criteria. The first article sample shall be rejected if it fails to meet any of the requirements of this specification. The Government reserves the right to terminate inspection and testing upon failure to meet any of the requirements of this specification.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Lotting. A lot shall consist of the coated cloth produced from no less than one lot or no more than four lots of base fabric coated by one manufacturer, at one plant, using the same materials and processes, and under essentially the same manufacturing conditions.

4.4.2 Sampling and inspection procedure.

4.4.2.1 Classification and marking of defects. Defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with tables II and IV. These defects shall be marked and flagged, on each sample roll examined, as follows: Major defects shall be flagged at the selvage edge with red thread or red masking tape. Minor defects shall be flagged at the selvage edge with white thread or white masking tape. All defects shall be circled with red or yellow crayon or marking pencil.

4.4.2.2 For visual examination. Twenty-five continuous yards selected at random from each sample roll shall be examined on one side only (see table II), however, the side shall be alternated so that alternate rolls are examined on the face and back, respectively. The same yardage shall be given a thorough lighting inspection for translucent areas. Defects found shall be counted regardless of their proximity to each other, except where two or more defects represent a single local condition of the coated cloth, in which case only the more serious defect shall be counted. A continuous defect shall be counted as one defect for each warpwise yard or fraction thereof in which it occurs. The sample size shall be in accordance with table III. The AQL (defined as specified in MIL-STD-109) shall be 4.0 for major and 6.0 total (major and minor combined) defects per 100 linear yards for the total yardage examined from the lot.

4.4.2.3 For overall examination. Each roll of coated cloth used in the visual examination shall be examined for the defects listed in table IV. If the total number of defects in the sample rolls exceeds the applicable acceptance number specified in table III or if the total of the actual lengths of the sample rolls is less than the total of the lengths marked on the roll tickets, the lot shall be rejected.

4.4.2.4 For test.

(a) Physical and chemical testing. For all characteristics, other than those for toxicological agent resistance, the coated and cured cloth shall be tested in accordance with the methods of testing specified in table V. The sample unit shall be four continuous yards, full width, of the coated and cured

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TABLE II. Visual examination of coated cloth

Defects	Classification	
	Major	Minor
Materials and Coating:		
Translucent areas more than three in a linear yard, clearly noticeable*	X	
Any pit, blister, abrasion, scratch or tunnel in the coating		X
Any delamination of the coating	X	
Any lump or embedded foreign material		X
Any uncoated area	X	
Any tackiness or soft coating (insufficient vulcanization)	X	
Uneven coating (missing or insufficent coating)	X	
Dry or burnt areas (over vulcanization)	X	
Heavily coated areas		X
Any brittle area which cracks when bent	X	
Finish not dull	X	
Workmanship:		
Any cut, hole or tear (including the selvage)		X
Any crease or wrinkle resulting in doubling, adhesion of surfaces, or delamination of coating when corrected by manual pressure	X	
Edges not straight and uniform, or edges folded rolled, or scalloped		X
Uneven tension (clearly noticeable ridges, pucker, or waviness in cloth that will not flatten under manual pressure)		X
Ripples, waviness, or dimensional distortion		X
Any spot, stain, or streak more than 1 inch in combined directions that cannot be readily removed with naphtha or water resulting in defective coating	X	
Any spot, stain, or streak not affecting coating		X
Spliced cloth (base fabric or coated cloth) or impression in coating from splicing threads	X	
Dusting powder omitted	X	
Odor		X

*The examination for translucent areas shall be performed in accordance with the through-light inspection procedure in MIL-STD-1487.

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TABLE III. Sampling for overall and visual examination

Lot size (rolls)	Sample size (rolls)	Acceptance number*
1 - 5	each roll	0
6 - 10	5	0
11 - 15	6	1
16 - 20	8	1
21 - 30	10	1
31 - 40	12	2
41 - 60	15	2
61 - 80	20	3
81 - 100	25	3
101 - 120	30	4
Over 120	35	4

*Applicable to overall examination only (see 4.4.2.3).

TABLE IV. Overall examination

Total length of roll less than 180 yards or more than 220 yards.
Total length of roll is two or more yards less than that marked on ticket.
Roll containing more than four pieces.
Any piece in roll less than 6 yards in length.
Width less than minimum specified.
Roll number missing, illegible, or not on heavy coated side.
Color or shade not as specified.
Ends of pieces in roll not overlapped, but joined by seam.

cloth. The sample size shall be two sample units for lots up to 800 yards, three sample units for lots of 800 to 10,000 yards, and five sample units from lots of over 10,000 yards. The lot shall be rejected if one or more sample unit fails to meet any of the requirements specified.

(b) Initial toxicological agent resistance. The initial toxicological agent resistance shall be as specified in table I when tested in accordance with table V. The sample size shall be in accordance with table VI. The sample unit shall be 18 continuous inches, full width. One sample unit drawn at random from each roll in the sample shall be used for testing initial HD and GB resistance. The sample unit shall contain the HEAVY SIDE marking or portion thereof.

4.4.3 Tests.

4.4.3.1 Resistance to HD. Resistance to permeation by HD shall be determined as specified in method 204 or T209 of MIL-STD-282. Four test specimens shall be randomly selected from the sample unit, but no specimen shall be taken

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TABLE V. Instructions for testing coated cloth

Characteristic	Footnote	Test Method	Determination per sample unit	Results Measured: Pass or Fail	Results Measured: To Nearest
Weight	*	FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 191 Method 5041	5		0.1 ounce
Puncture strength	*	4.4.3.11	5		0.2 pound
Breaking strength					
Initial	*	ASTM D 751	5		1.0 pound
After weather-ometer	**	ASTM D 751 and 4.4.3.7	5		1.0 pound
After decontamination	**	ASTM D 751 and 4.4.3.8	5		1.0 pound
Hydrostatic resistance	*, ***	ASTM D 751 and 4.4.3.9	10		0.5 pound
Bow and bias	*	4.4.3.10	1		0.1 inch
Adhesion of coating	*	FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 191 Method 5970	5		0.5 pound
Abrasion resistance	*, *****	FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 191 Method 5302	5	X	
Stiffness	*, ****	FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 191 Method 5204.1	5		0.1 cm
HD resistance					
Initial	*	4.4.3.1			minute
After weather-ometer	**	4.4.3.3			minute
After decontamination	**	4.4.3.5			minute

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TABLE V. Instructions for testing coated cloth - Continued

Characteristic	Footnote	Test Method	Determination per sample unit	Results measured: Pass or Fail	Results measured: To Nearest
GB resistance					
Initial	*	4.4.3.2			minute
After weatherometer	**	4.4.3.4			minute
After decontamination	**	4.4.3.6			minute
Blocking	*	FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 191 Method 5872	3	X	
Color fastness					
After weatherometer	**	4.4.3.7	1	X	
After decontamination	**	4.4.3.8	1	X	

*This test shall be performed on first article and regular production samples.

**This test shall be performed on first article samples only unless otherwise deemed necessary to assure the quality of the coated cloth is as specified herein.

***The lightly coated side (or either side if the coating is equally distributed on both sides) shall contact with water.

****Test specimens shall be conditioned at test temperatures specified for a minimum of 4 hours. All tests shall be conducted in still air.

*****The following exceptions to method 5302 shall apply:

a. The heavier coated side (or either side if the coating is equally distributed on both sides) shall be tested.
b. No metallic contact pin shall be used.
c. The specimens shall be abraded 100 multidirectional cycles using fine emery cloth as the abradant.
d. Before cutting the test specimens, the coated cloth shall be cleaned by washing with mild soap and water, rinsing in distilled water, and drying at room temperature.

within 2 inches of the selvage. Determinations shall be made on the heavy coated side of the cloth or on either side if the coating is equally distributed on both sides. If any specimen tested fails to meet the requirements of table I, the material shall be rejected.

4.4.3.2 Resistance to GB. Resistance to permeation by GB shall be determined as specified in method 206 or T208 of MIL-STD-282. Eight test specimens shall be randomly selected across the width of the sample unit, but no specimen

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shall be taken within 2 inches from the selvage. Determinations shall be made on the heavy coated side of the cloth or on either side if the coating is equally distributed on both sides. If any specimen tested fails to meet the requirements of table I, the material shall be rejected.

TABLE VI. Sampling for agent resistance tests

Lot size (rolls)	Sample size (rolls)	Acceptance number
1 - 5	each roll	0
6 - 10	4	0
11 - 15	6	0
16 - 20	8	0
21 - 30	10	0
31 - 40	15	1
41 - 60	20	1
61 - 80	30	2
81 - 100	40	3
101 - 120	50	4
Over 120	60	5

4.4.3.3 Resistance to HD after accelerated weathering. Test specimens shall first be exposed to accelerated weathering as specified in 4.4.3.7 and then tested for HD resistance as specified in 4.4.3.1.

4.4.3.4 Resistance to GB after accelerated weathering. Test specimens shall first be exposed to accelerated weathering as specified in 4.4.3.7 and then tested for GB resistance as specified in 4.4.3.2.

4.4.3.5 Resistance to HD after decontamination. Test specimens shall first be subjected to decontamination as specified in 4.4.3.8 and then tested for HD resistance as specified in 4.4.3.1.

4.4.3.6 Resistance to GB after decontamination. Test specimens shall first be subjected to decontamination as specified in 4.4.3.8 and then tested for GB resistance as specified in 4.4.3.2.

4.4.3.7 Weatherometer test. The test shall be performed with filters for a period of 100 hours on specimens 4 inches by 6 inches minimum with the heavy coated side (or either side if the coating is equally distributed on both sides) of the cloth exposed as specified in method 5804 of FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 191. After exposure, the specimens shall be allowed to dry and then be conditioned at standard conditions for 4 hours.

4.4.3.8 Decontamination procedure. Strips of coated cloth, 10 inches by 22 inches, shall be cut along both the warp and fill directions. The strips shall be immersed for 10 minutes in a decontamination slurry made of Super Tropical

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Bleach (STB) conforming to MIL-D-12468 at a concentration of 50 pounds of STB per 5 gallons of water (see 6.3). At the end of 10 minutes, the strips shall be removed from the slurry and immersed in 4 gallons of boiling water for 2 hours. At the end of the 2 hours, the strips shall be removed from the wash and air dried at room temperature before testing.

4.4.3.9 Hydrostatic resistance. The test shall be performed in accordance with ASTM D 751, method A, procedure 2, except that the specified pressure shall be applied against the test specimen for a period of 2 minutes. The lightly coated side (or either side if the coating is equally distributed on both sides) shall contact the water.

4.4.3.10 Bow and bias. One end of each sample unit shall be tested for bow and bias of fill yarns. A strip shall be torn across the full width of the sample unit sufficiently to expose a continuous fill yarn. A line perpendicular to either selvage edge shall be drawn across the full width of the sample unit, close to, but not intersecting the exposed fill yarn. If the selvage edges are folded, rolled, puckered, scalloped, or otherwise not straight, a 1/2 inch strip parallel to one selvage edge shall be drawn to establish a straight edge from which to draw the perpendicular line. The least and greatest distance between the perpendicular line and the exposed fill yarn shall be measured parallel to the selvage edges. The difference between these measurements is the bow and bias of the fill yarns which shall not exceed the maximum specified.

4.4.3.11 Puncture strength. The test specimen shall be clamped tautly across the top of a suitable holder (see 6.5) so that the piercing instrument will be applied to the heavy coated side (or either side if the coating is equally distributed on both sides) of the cloth. The specimen holder shall have an opening approximately 3 inches in diameter. The piercing instrument (see figure 1) shall be placed against the cloth at approximately the center of the specimen with the flat piercing end of the instrument parallel to the cloth. The force shall be applied gradually and a suitable means employed to measure the force. The force required to puncture the cloth shall be no less than the minimum specified.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. The coated cloth shall be packaged in accordance with PPP-P-1136.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The coated cloth covered by this specification is intended for use in the fabrication of CBR protective hoods.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Applicable levels of put-up, preservation and packing.
(c) First article

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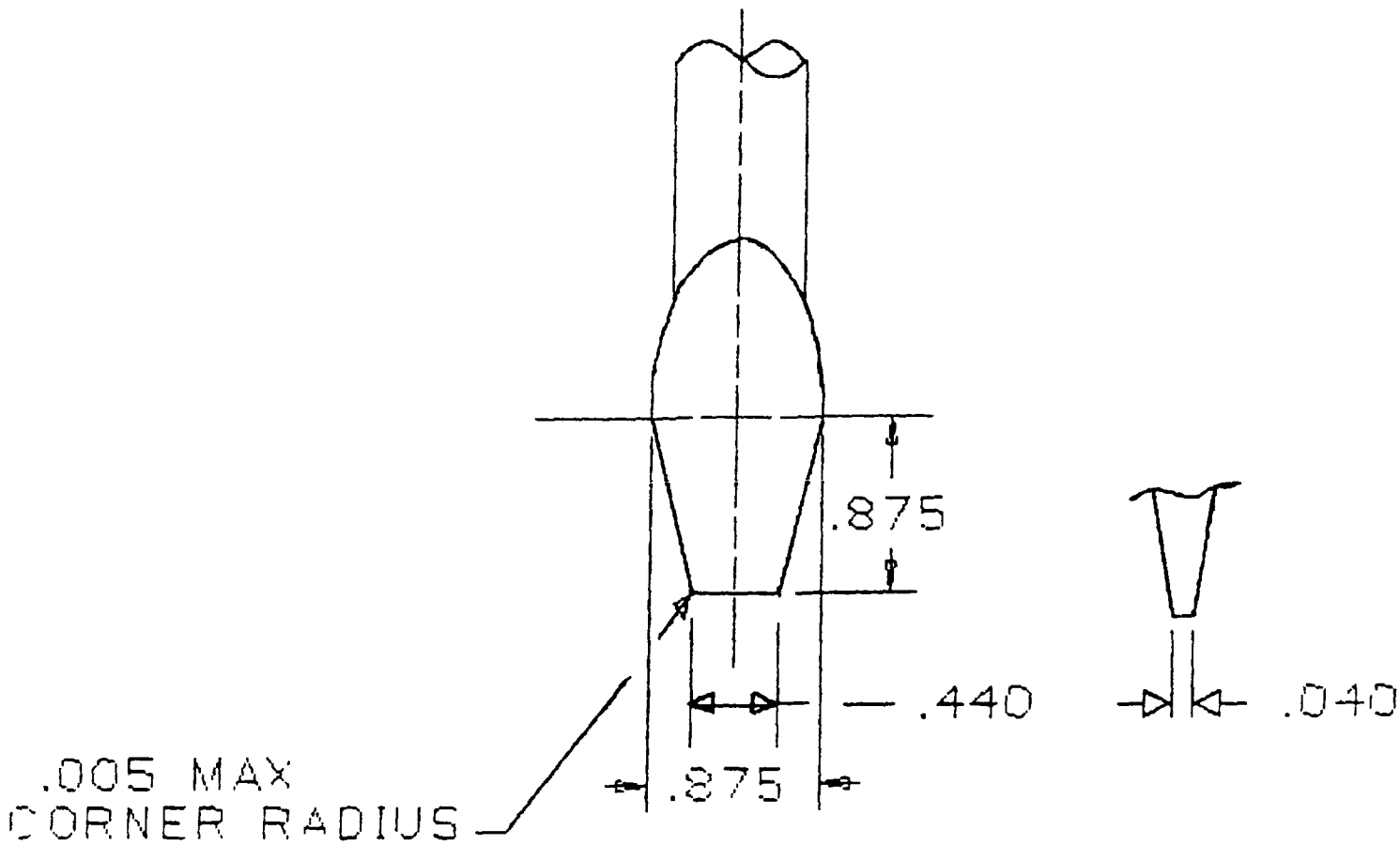


FIGURE 1. Piercing instrument

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(1) Time allowed for contractor submission for Government test and evaluation after award of contract.

(2) Name and address of test facility when testing is performed by the Government.

(3) Time required for the Government to notify the contractor whether to proceed with production.

(d) Width of rolls.

(e) Color of finished cloth.

6.3 STB testing precautions. STB is corrosive to most metals and is injurious to most fabrics. A protective mask and gloves should be worn when handling this material.

6.4 Adhesive. A solventless adhesive "Number 910" made by Tennessee Eastman Company, Kingsport, TN, and distributed by Armstrong Cork Company, Lancaster, PA, has been found suitable for the adhesion of coating test.

6.5 Puncture strength holder. A mason jar has been found to be a suitable specimen holder.

6.6 Warning. In order to meet the requirements for resistance to toxicological agents, a dense, non-porous coating is required. (A dense coating is defined as one where the cross-section has no voids visible at 60 times magnification. Coatings which are marginal with respect to porosity will result in a high percentage of rejection.) To obtain such a coating, a more exacting technique must be used than is common practice in industry.

6.7 Color. The color of the finished packaged cloth will be specified by the purchaser in order to assure the correct color of the end item that will be manufactured from the cloth.

6.8 Subject term (key word listing).

Cloth, coated
Cloth, parachute

Custodian:

Army - EA

Preparing activity:

Army - EA

Project No. 8305-A247

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-51251A(EA)	CLOTH, COATED; CBR PROTECTIVE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*

4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark*

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording.

b. Recommended Wording.

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation.

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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